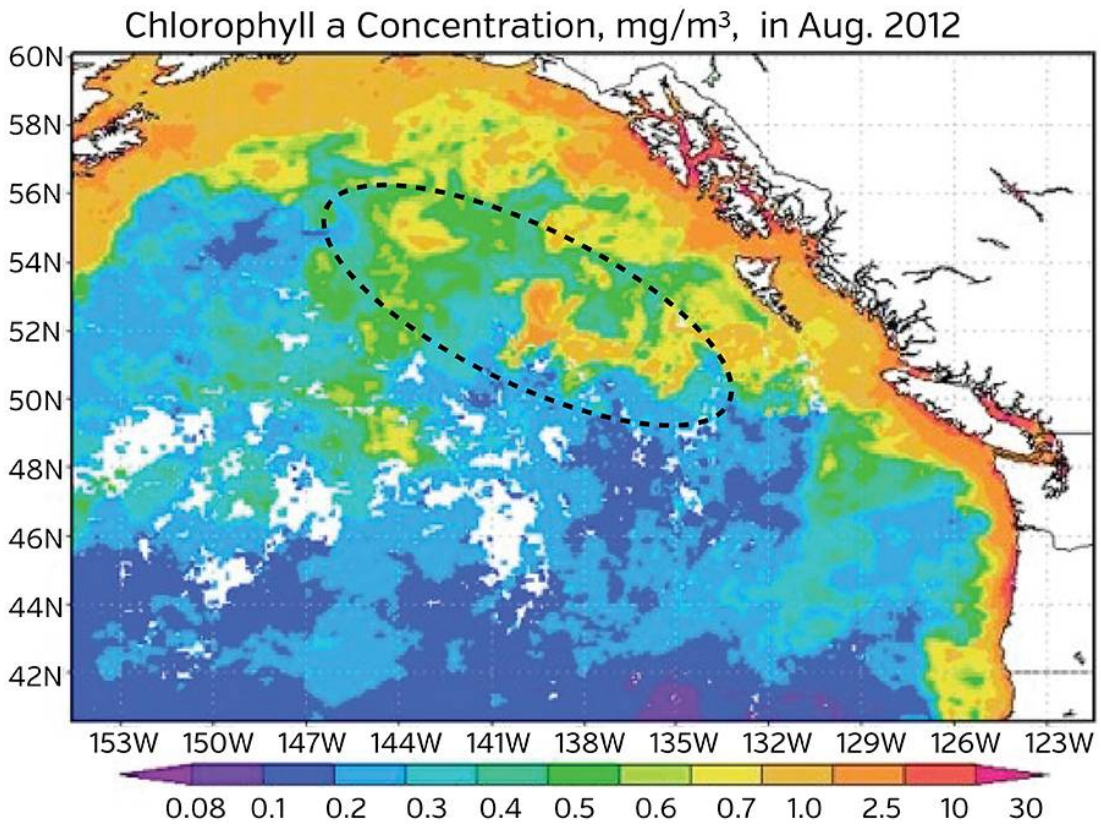


Fig. 11.2. Map of chlorophyll concentration (algae) after dumping 100 tons of iron sulphate into the ocean off the coast of British Columbia. Iron-stimulated algae growth produced the high algae concentration inside the dashed ellipse. *[From Giovanni/Goddard Earth Sciences Data and Information Services Center/NASA.]*

Meyerowitz: Ultraviolet light, streaming through our atmosphere's ozone hole, could mutate your enormous bloom of algae so it creates new pathogens. These pathogens could wipe out plants in the ocean, and then jump to land and start wiping out crops.

Baltimore: When faced with catastrophes like these, our only hope for dealing with them is advanced science and technology. If, politically, we don't invest in science and technology, or we hobble them by anti-intellectual ideologies such as denial of evolution, the very source of these catastrophes, we may find ourselves without the solutions we need.